

Droid Catcher — Player Guide

Beta build v0.0.9

● **Blue text** marks what's new in version 0.0.9. Skim for blue if you've read a previous version of this guide and just want to catch up.

✧ Upcoming: Summer Event

Starting Friday 7th August, running for 7 days. Eight brand-new Solar-collection droids — Sunbud, Solara, Sundrift, Solaris Rex, Scorchling, Heatfang, Dustwraith, and Infernotitan — will start appearing on the radar. They **only** spawn during this window, so get hunting while it's live. Once caught, they're yours for good — they just live in a separate Event Dex rather than your main one.

What's New in 0.0.9 — Field Ops

A whole new tab, **Field Ops**, with three new ways to earn materials and droids:

- **Depot** — a ring-timing minigame you can play once an hour (100♦ per attempt). How close you stop the pulse ring to the target ring decides how good your crystal payout is (50-200♦) — but Paint and Nova Chip odds stay the same no matter how well you play.
- **Factory** — a bigger commitment: buy Processor slots (up to 5, each pricier than the last), win an egg from the same ring minigame, assign it to a slot and pay to start a 20-hour incubation, then collect. What hatches is a straight rarity roll — skill gets you the egg, not the quality of what's inside. You can crush an unwanted egg (before or during incubation) for a small chance at a Nova Chip.
- **Beacons** — a consumable you can buy and activate: for 30 minutes, your scans have noticeably better odds of turning up something Rare or better. Since spawns are shared once they appear, anyone else nearby benefits too.

Also: keep an eye out for short, intense spawn bursts — sometimes Legendaries, sometimes companions — that come and go in just 10 minutes. Nothing you can trigger yourself, but worth jumping on when you spot one.

Navigating the App

The game is organized into tabs across the top:

Tab	What's there
Player	Login, your stats, Control Pad upgrades, Cosmetics
Capture	The radar — scan for droids and run the capture minigame
Farm	Crystal balance, totals, Collect button, Workshop slots (with droids shown inline)
Companion	Your equipped companion, its buff, activation status, and any others you own
Storage	Droids not currently farming — level up, evolve, release, assign, or tap for full stats
Field Ops	Depot, Factory/Processors, and Beacons — see above
Guilds	Create/join a guild, see members, chat, and the Dex leaderboard
Inventory	Crystals, Paint, Nova Chips, and redeeming promo codes
Trading	Trading and the public Wishlist board
Dex	Your collection progress, plus the separate Event Dex

Tap any tab to switch — your data stays loaded, nothing resets.

Getting Started

1. Deploy your pilot (Player tab). Enter a callsign (username) and a 4-8 digit PIN, then hit "Deploy / Resume Pilot."

- New callsign → creates a fresh pilot.

- Existing callsign + matching PIN → resumes that pilot, even on a different phone or browser. Your PIN is how you log back in anywhere.
 - Pick a PIN you'll remember — there's no "forgot PIN" recovery yet.
- 2. Choose your starter droid.** You'll be offered a free Common-tier droid — pick Light or Dark, whichever collection appeals to you. It starts farming crystals immediately, no capturing required.
- 3. Scan for droids** (Capture tab). Hit "Use My Location & Scan" — this uses your phone/browser's real GPS location to find droids nearby. You'll need to allow location access when prompted.

The Core Loop

Droid Catcher runs on one loop: **capture droids → they farm crystals for you → spend crystals to capture/upgrade more droids.**

- Droids you assign to a Workshop Slot (Farm tab) passively generate crystals over time (shown as crystals/minute).
- Crystals are the only currency for almost everything: capturing, leveling, unlocking slots, upgrading your pad, evolving droids, and buying cosmetics.
- Watch your crystal balance** — the Control Pad literally needs crystals to function. You can't attempt a capture with zero.

Capturing Droids

On the Capture tab, tap any droid on the radar to open its capture panel.

The LOCK-ON minigame: a marker sweeps back and forth across a bar. A highlighted "zone" marks your target window — the closer to the center you stop the marker, the higher your accuracy. Rarer droids have a narrower zone (harder to time), which is why Legendaries are a real test of skill, not just luck.

Crystals matter too: each droid has a minimum crystal cost just to attempt it (scales with rarity). Spending more than the minimum, up to a cap, improves your odds further.

Risk is real: if the capture fails, your spent crystals are gone for good — there's no refund. **Critical captures:** upgrading your Control Pad gives you a chance at a guaranteed success. **After every attempt,** a popup tells you exactly what happened.

Droid Types

Alignment: every droid is Light ✨, Dark ●, or the ultra-rare Cosmic ✦ (companions only). Light droids spawn more often during the day, Dark droids more often at night.

Collections: Mythical, Nature / Corrupted Nature, and Wildcard spawn normally. Solar only exists during the Summer Event.

Rarity: Common → Uncommon → Rare → Legendary → Cosmic (companions only).

Icon Glossary

Icon	Meaning
✨	Light alignment
●	Dark alignment
✦	Cosmic alignment (companion droids only)
🗳️	This exact droid (species + variant) is already in your Dex
🎨	Paint — spend on a Rusty droid to evolve it to Funky
🍳	Nova Chips — spend to evolve certain species, or won from Depot / crushing eggs
👑	Marks the creator of a guild
"e" badge	Evolution-only species — never spawns in the wild
Small dots on a Dex entry	Rusty, Platinum, Funky caught status
🥚	An unassigned egg, waiting for a Processor slot (Factory)

Variants — The Shiny Hunt

Any droid has a small chance of coming up as a special variant, visible on the radar before you capture it:

- **Platinum** — 5x crystal production.
- **Rusty** — 2x crystal production, can be evolved further.
- **Funky** — an evolved Rusty: a chosen color and 3.5x production.

Paint & Funky Evolution

Any successful capture has a small chance to drop Paint. [The Depot also has a flat chance of dropping Paint on every visit.](#) Spend Paint on a Rusty droid (from Storage) to evolve it into Funky — pick a color, get the upgraded rate.

Species Evolution

Some species evolve using Nova Chips — earned by releasing droids, [from Depot visits, or from crushing an unwanted Factory egg.](#) Evolving keeps your droid's level and variant.

Releasing Droids

Release a droid for 1.5x its capture cost back, plus a chance at a Nova Chip. Select multiple and hit "Release Selected" for one combined result. Starter droids and hatched Prototypes refund nothing (they were free) but can still drop a chip.

The Farm Tab

10 total Workshop Slots (1 free, rest cost crystals to unlock). Every farming droid shows in its slot — tap to level up or unassign. Total Rate and Active Buff summarize your whole farm at a glance.

The Storage Tab

Only droids not currently farming. Sorted by rarity, species, variant. Tap for full stats. Level up, evolve, release, or assign — all from the same row.

The Field Ops Tab

Depot — spend 100+ and play the ring minigame: a pulse ring grows outward, tap STOP as close as you can to the static target ring. Land inside it for a good payout, overshoot for a small one — you always get something. 1-hour cooldown after each visit.

Beacon — buy for 300+, Activate, and for 30 minutes your scans lean rarer. Only one active at a time.

Factory — the bigger loop:

1. Buy a Processor slot (up to 5, escalating cost).
2. Play the ring minigame (100+) to try winning an egg — here, accuracy only decides hit-or-miss. A miss costs the crystals but not your cooldown, so retry immediately. A hit starts a 3-hour cooldown.
3. Assign an egg to an empty slot, pay 100+, start a 20-hour incubation.
4. Collect once ready — a fixed rarity roll (Legendary 5% / Rare 15% / Uncommon 30% / Common ~50% / Cosmic 0.01%) independent of minigame skill.
5. Or Crush an unwanted egg (unassigned or mid-incubation) for a smaller Nova Chip chance.

Control Pad Upgrades

On the Player tab. Raises critical-capture chance and the accuracy-skill ceiling in LOCK-ON. Account-wide, not per-droid.

Companion Droids

Two Cosmic-tier companions, equip one for a passive buff:

- **StarSprite** — +50% total crystal production, always active while equipped.
- **Nebulfox** — +100% capture success chance. Needs activating: runs 1 hour, then an 8-hour cooldown *per droid* — own two, stagger them.

Time-Exclusive Events

Watch the event banner above the radar on the Capture tab. Some run for hours, [some for a sharp 10-minute burst](#). The Summer Event is the biggest — 8 entirely new Solar droids.

Trading & Wishlist

Propose a trade using another player's ID — offer droids, optionally request droids and/or crystals back; gifts are fine too. Post a Wishlist entry (droid or Paint, with preferences) visible to everyone with your Player ID attached; anyone can offer a trade straight from it.

Guilds

Create/join a guild (up to 12). See members with a 🏰 for the creator, a Dex Leaderboard, and Chat (refreshes on tab visit, not instant). The creator can kick a member — 24h before they can join any guild again, 30 days before rejoining that one.

Cosmetics & Redeem Codes

Buy the Beta Crown (1000✦, bragging rights only) on the Player tab. Enter promo codes on the Inventory tab for crystals, Paint, Nova Chips, and/or a droid — once per player per code.

The Dex

Every species you've caught, with variant dots and an "e" badge for evolution-only species. Stays "caught" even after trading/releasing. [Event Dex](#) holds Summer-Event-exclusive species separately, not counted toward main completion.

Quick Tips

- Don't spend crystals below a droid's minimum — it's rejected, nothing lost.
- Failed captures still cost the crystals spent.
- Level up before releasing — refunds are based on capture cost, not level.
- Activate Nebulfox right before a hunting session, not idly.
- Check the radar in both day and night for a different Light/Dark mix.
- [A Beacon is best activated right before a longer session — the 30 minutes ticks down regardless.](#)
- [Crush spare Factory eggs early if your Processor slots are full — an idle egg does nothing.](#)
- Post to the Wishlist early for anything you're missing.

Roadmap — What's Coming

- **PVE raid battles** — the HP/Attack stats every droid has are groundwork for this.
- **Guild-vs-guild PVP** — building on the guild system's current depth.
- **Paint-fulfillable wishes via trade** — currently need manual coordination.
- **Real character art** — droids currently show added artwork or a placeholder icon.

Thanks for testing — report anything confusing, broken, or just plain unfun. That's exactly what this round is for.